

HR POLICY MANUAL FOR SHOPSPHERE INNOVATIONS

Industry: E-Commerce & Retail Technology

Employees: 40–80

Company Description: ShopSphere Innovations provides online retail solutions and digital marketplace services, helping small businesses expand their reach through technology-driven platforms.

1. Introduction

ShopSphere Innovations is committed to creating a positive, productive, and professional work environment where employees can perform their duties effectively while maintaining a healthy work-life balance. As a growing e-commerce and retail technology startup, we recognize that our employees are the foundation of our success.

This Human Resource (HR) Policy Manual provides guidelines regarding employee leave, workplace conduct, and work-from-home arrangements. The purpose of these policies is to establish clear expectations, promote fairness, ensure compliance with organizational values, and support employee well-being.

All employees are expected to familiarize themselves with and adhere to the policies outlined in this document. These policies apply to all full-time, part-time, contractual, and temporary employees unless otherwise specified by management.

2. Leave Policy

2.1 Purpose

ShopSphere Innovations recognizes the importance of providing employees with adequate time off for rest, personal commitments, health concerns, and emergencies. The leave policy aims to maintain employee well-being while ensuring uninterrupted business operations and customer service excellence.

2.2 Types of Leave

A. Casual Leave

Employees are entitled to **12 days of casual leave per calendar year**.

Guidelines:

- Casual leave should be applied for at least two working days in advance whenever possible.
- Leave approval is subject to managerial discretion and workload requirements.
- Unused casual leave cannot be carried forward to the next year.
- Casual leave is intended for personal work, family commitments, or short-term requirements.

B. Sick Leave

Employees are entitled to **8 days of paid sick leave annually**.

Guidelines:

- Employees must notify their reporting manager as soon as possible.
- Medical documentation may be requested for absences exceeding two consecutive days.
- Sick leave should be used only for genuine illness or medical emergencies.
- Misuse of sick leave may result in disciplinary action.

C. Earned Leave

Employees completing one year of continuous service may become eligible for earned leave.

Guidelines:

- Earned leave may be accumulated and carried forward as per company regulations.
- Approval from the department manager is mandatory.
- Employees should apply at least one week before planned leave.

D. Emergency Leave

Emergency leave may be granted in situations such as:

- Family emergencies
- Medical emergencies
- Accidents
- Natural disasters

Employees should inform their manager immediately and submit supporting documents if requested.

E. Maternity and Paternity Leave

ShopSphere Innovations supports employees during important family events.

- Female employees may avail maternity leave in accordance with applicable labor laws.
- Male employees may be granted paternity leave subject to company approval.

F. Unpaid Leave

When paid leave balances are exhausted, employees may request unpaid leave.

Conditions:

- Requires management approval.
- Salary deductions will apply for the approved leave period.
- Frequent requests may be reviewed by HR.

2.3 Leave Application Procedure

1. Submit leave requests through the HR portal or official company email.
2. Obtain approval from the reporting manager.
3. HR will record and process approved leave requests.
4. Employees should ensure proper work handover before extended absences.

3. Code of Conduct

3.1 Purpose

The Code of Conduct establishes standards of professional behavior expected from all employees at ShopSphere Innovations. It promotes respect, integrity, accountability, innovation, and teamwork.

3.2 Professionalism

Employees are expected to:

- Maintain professional behavior at all times.

- Demonstrate honesty and integrity.
- Respect organizational policies and procedures.
- Represent ShopSphere Innovations positively when interacting with customers, vendors, and stakeholders.

3.3 Respect and Equality

ShopSphere Innovations is committed to providing an inclusive workplace free from discrimination.

Employees must not engage in discrimination based on:

- Gender
- Age
- Religion
- Race
- Nationality
- Disability
- Marital status

All employees must treat colleagues, customers, suppliers, and business partners with dignity and respect.

3.4 Anti-Harassment Policy

The company maintains a zero-tolerance policy toward harassment.

Examples include:

- Verbal abuse
- Offensive jokes
- Threats
- Bullying
- Sexual harassment
- Intimidation

Any employee experiencing or witnessing harassment should immediately report the matter to HR.

3.5 Attendance and Punctuality

Employees are expected to:

- Arrive at work on time.
- Follow designated working hours.
- Inform supervisors about delays or absences.
- Maintain regular attendance.

Repeated absenteeism or lateness may result in disciplinary action.

3.6 Confidentiality

Employees are responsible for protecting confidential information including:

- Customer information
- Seller and vendor data
- Business strategies
- Financial records
- Employee records
- Intellectual property

Unauthorized disclosure of confidential information is strictly prohibited.

3.7 Conflict of Interest

Employees must avoid situations where personal interests conflict with company interests.

Examples include:

- Accepting inappropriate gifts from vendors.
- Working for competing e-commerce businesses without approval.
- Using company resources for personal gain.

3.8 Company Property

Employees must use company assets responsibly.

These include:

- Computers
- Laptops
- Software licenses
- Internet access
- Office equipment
- Company databases

Damage, loss, or misuse must be reported immediately.

3.9 Social Media Conduct

Employees should:

- Maintain professionalism online.
- Avoid sharing confidential company information.
- Refrain from posting content that may damage the company's reputation.
- Respect customer privacy and data protection policies.

3.10 Disciplinary Action

Violation of company policies may result in:

- Verbal warning
- Written warning
- Suspension
- Termination of employment

The severity of disciplinary action depends on the nature of the violation.

4. Work-from-Home (WFH) Guidelines

4.1 Purpose

The Work-from-Home Policy enables employees to perform their duties remotely while maintaining productivity, accountability, communication, and customer service standards.

4.2 Eligibility

Work-from-home arrangements may be granted to:

- Full-time employees
- Contract employees (where applicable)
- Employees whose roles can be effectively performed remotely

Approval must be obtained from the reporting manager.

4.3 Working Hours

Employees working remotely are expected to:

- Follow regular business hours.
- Remain available during core working periods.
- Attend virtual meetings and discussions.
- Notify supervisors of any availability issues.

4.4 Communication Requirements

Employees should:

- Check emails regularly.
- Respond to messages promptly.
- Attend scheduled video meetings.
- Provide daily or weekly progress updates.

Communication platforms may include:

- Microsoft Teams
- Zoom
- Google Meet
- Slack

4.5 Productivity Expectations

Remote employees must:

- Complete assigned tasks on schedule.

- Meet performance expectations.
- Maintain quality standards.
- Submit deliverables within deadlines.
- Ensure smooth coordination with customers, vendors, and internal teams.

Performance evaluations remain consistent regardless of work location.

4.6 Data Security and Confidentiality

Employees must:

- Use secure internet connections.
- Protect company devices.
- Maintain strong passwords.
- Avoid sharing confidential information.
- Report cybersecurity incidents immediately.

Unauthorized access to company systems is strictly prohibited.

4.7 Workspace Requirements

Employees should maintain:

- A quiet working environment.
- Reliable internet connectivity.
- Suitable equipment for job performance.
- Safe and ergonomic working conditions.

4.8 Health and Well-Being

Employees are encouraged to:

- Take regular breaks.
 - Maintain work-life balance.
 - Follow ergonomic practices.
 - Seek support when facing work-related stress.
-

5. Conclusion

ShopSphere Innovations believes that clear and transparent HR policies contribute to a productive, respectful, and supportive workplace. The Leave Policy, Code of Conduct, and Work-from-Home Guidelines outlined in this document provide a framework for employee success and organizational growth.

All employees are expected to comply with these policies and contribute positively to the company's culture, values, and mission of empowering small businesses through innovative e-commerce and retail technology solutions.